

HR MANUAL

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INTRODUCTION

M/S TECHAHEAD SOFTWARE PVT. LTD. (hereinafter referred to as “TECHAHEAD”/ “Company”) welcomes you to the organization and we look forward to working with you. Our success is founded on the skill and effort of our trainees. We strive to make the Company a good place to work and a place where you will be treated fairly and with dignity. The Company would like to help you get off to a good start.

The first thing you should do is read this HR Manual carefully.

This HR Manual is designed to answer many of your questions about the policies and procedures that apply to your employment with the Company, to serve as a reference for questions concerning the Company’s policies as they particularly affect you, and to provide general information about Leaves and other benefits the Company offers to you.

This HR Manual supersedes all previous personnel policies and procedures of TECHAHEAD (formal and informal). The policies and procedures contained in this HR Manual are binding upon the trainees of TECHAHEAD and the same is acknowledged at the time of taking up the employment. The Company reserves the right to add/ edit/ delete contents of the Manual at any time to reflect the updates in policies and procedures that the Company follows.

The company attempts to provide written notice of any major change to trainees or to post such a notice in a place accessible to trainees before the effective date of the change. The latest amended version of the policy will govern the HR Policy.

This HR Manual is the property of the Company. You have been provided with a copy of the same for reading and referring to during your employment with the Company. On termination of your employment for any reason or upon request by the Company at any time, this HR Manual must be returned immediately. Please read all the policies and procedures in this HR Manual, as each trainee will be required to sign an Acknowledgment to the effect that he or she has read and agrees to abide by the policies and procedures contained in the HR Manual.

Please do not hesitate to ask for help with any questions that may arise. Should you have any questions that are not answered in this HR Manual, your supervisor or another member of Company management will be glad to help.

Human Resource Department
TechAhead Software Pvt Ltd
Plot No-B8, 7A Floor, Tower-C,
Noida One, Sector-62,
Noida, Uttar Pradesh 201301

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THE COMPANY- OVERVIEW

Established in the year 2009, M/S TECHAHEAD SOFTWARE PRIVATE LIMITED is an Indian Private Limited Company which is a pioneer in the field of mobile application development and IT services and engaged in the designing and development of applications for Web, iPhones, iPads and Android-powered devices in India. The Company has a global clientele and provides high-quality IT solutions to its customers.

TECHAHEAD is committed to maintaining the highest level of professionalism, honesty, integrity, and fairness in its transactions with its clients and pledges to continue with the same.

1) GENERAL MANAGEMENT PRACTICE

1.1 Equal Employment Policy

That the term “Trainee(s)” in this HR Manual shall mean and include permanent trainees as well as the probationers until and unless expressly stated. This HR Manual shall not apply or include Contractual trainees until and unless specifically stated herein.

It is the policy of TECHAHEAD to provide equal employment opportunities to all its trainees and applicants for employment and not to discriminate on any basis prohibited by law, including race, color, sex, religion, national origin, disability, marital status, or any other status or condition protected by the applicable center, state, or local laws except where a bona fide occupational qualification applies. It is the intent and desire of the Company that equal employment opportunities be provided in employment, recruitment, selection, compensation, benefits, promotion, demotion, layoff, termination, and all other related employment procedures of the Company. The Manager HR, at TECHAHEAD and all its managerial personnel, are committed to this policy and its enforcement.

Trainees are directed to bring any violation of this policy to the immediate attention of their reporting manager or the Head of HR, of TECHAHEAD. Any trainee who violates this policy or knowingly retaliates against an trainee reporting or complaining of a violation of this policy shall be subject to immediate disciplinary action, up to and including termination from services. Complaints brought under this policy will be promptly investigated and handled with due regard for the privacy and respect of all involved.

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1.2 **Employment Classification:**

For the sole purpose of determining the allowance of certain trainee benefits, trainees are classified as:

- i) CEO
- ii) CC&CSO
 - (1) VP, Sales & Marketing
 - (a) Sales Managers & Executive
 - (b) Marketing Managers & Executives
- iii) CTO
- iv) COO
 - (1) VP – Delivery
 - (a) Sr. Project Manager
 - (b) Project Manager
 - (c) Technical Delivery Manager
 - (d) Associate Technical Delivery Manager
 - (e) Business Analyst
 - (2) Architects/Manager Technology
 - (a) Tech Lead
 - (b) Associate Tech Lead
 - (i) Sr. Software Engineer
 - (ii) Software Engineer
 - (iii) Associate Software Engineer
 - (iv) Software Trainee
 - (3) QA Manager
 - (a) QA Lead
 - (i) Associate Lead QA
 - 1. Sr. Software Engineer - Testing
 - 2. Software Engineer Testing
 - 3. Associate Software Engineer Testing
 - 4. Trainee QA
 - (4) Head of Design
 - (a) Creative Head
 - (b) UI UX Designer

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- (c) UI Developer
- (d) Trainee
- (5) Assoc. Director HR
 - (a) Manager Human Resource
 - (b) Sr. Executive HR
 - (c) Executive HR
- (6) GM Operations
 - (a) Admin
 - (b) System Admin
- (7) Finance and Accounts

1.3 **Harassment Prevention Policy**

1.3.1 Policy related to General Harassment: -

Commitment

TECHAHEAD is committed to providing a work environment that ensures every trainee is treated with dignity and respect and is afforded equitable treatment. TECHAHEAD will not tolerate harassment or intimidation of any trainee on any basis prohibited by law, including race, color, sex, age, religion, national origin, sexual preferences, physical disability, marital status, veteran status, etc. within the office premises or outside at the time of carrying out of his/her duty on behalf the Company. Moreover, any suggestions made to any trainee that any type of favors will affect any term or condition of employment with TECHAHEAD will not be tolerated. It is the policy of TECHAHEAD that any harassment, including acts creating a hostile work environment or any other discriminatory acts directed against its trainees, will result in immediate disciplinary action, and may include termination from services. TECHAHEAD also will not tolerate any such harassment or intimidation of its trainees by clients or vendors.

Scope:

This policy shall apply to all the trainees of TECHAHEAD including any trainee engaged in fixed-term short-term, permanent, temporary, apprentice, trainees, contract persons, and visitors on the Company's premises. It shall include the unwelcome behavior of sexual nature mentioned in the policy or sending vulgar and obscene image(s)/video(s)/video clipping(s)/message(s)/text(s) or passing remarks which are derogatory

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or hurts the religious sentiments of any staff and/or member of the Company by any of its trainee's suppliers, contractor including the agents, supervisors, managers, etc.

Workplace:

The workplace includes: -

1. All offices or other premises where TECHAHEAD's business is conducted.
2. All Company-related activities performed at any other site away from the Company's premises.
3. Any social, business, or other functions where the conduct or comments may hurt the workplace or workplace relations.

1.3.2 Policy related to Sexual Harassment: -

Sexual harassment in the workplace is considered a violation of women's right to equality, life, and liberty. It creates an insecure and hostile work environment, which discourages women's participation in work, thereby adversely affecting their social and economic empowerment and the goal of inclusive growth.

TechAhead, in the light of "The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013" has incorporated this harassment prevention policy to ensure that the women trainees at TechAhead feel safe, secure, and progressive.

Please note that the POSH Policy is documented and updated separately. Trainees are advised to go through the policy in detail to ensure awareness and compliance

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2) CODE OF CONDUCT

It is the policy of TECHAHEAD to provide a code of conduct for its trainees which will serve as a guide to the proper business conduct of all the trainees of the Company. TECHAHEAD expects all the trainees to observe the highest code of conduct and integrity in their conduct. This means following a basic code of such ethical behavior that includes the followings: -

2.1 Build Trust and Credibility

The growth of TECHAHEAD and its trainees is dependent on the trust and the confidence it earns from its trainees, customers, clients, and shareholders. The Company gains credibility by adhering to its commitments, displaying honesty and integrity, and reaching Company's goal solely through honorable conduct.

2.2 Respect for the Individual

All the trainees of TECHAHEAD are required to work in an environment where everyone is treated with dignity and respect which, in turn, contributes directly to the success of the Company. This policy provides the framework of principles for conducting business and dealing with customers, colleagues, and other stakeholders which are to:

- i) Act with integrity and professionalism and be scrupulous in the proper use of Company information, funds, equipment mentoring, and facilities.
- ii) Exercise fairness, equity, proper courtesy, consideration, and sensitivity in dealing with customers, trainees, and other stakeholders; and
- iii) Avoid real or apparent conflict of interests.

2.3 Responsibilities

- i) Trainees are required to promote the interests of the Company.
- ii) Perform their duties with skill, honesty, care, and diligence, using authority fairly and equitably.
- iii) Abide by policies and procedures, instructions, and lawful directions that relate to their employment and duties; and

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- iv) Comply with the spirit as well as the letter of the codes of conduct applying to the professions of individual Trainees.
- v) Apprise Employer about any inappropriate or unethical or illegal activity taking place within the premises of TechAhead.

2.4 Gifts, Favor, and Conflict of Interest

- i) Trainees must avoid any personal, financial, or other conflict of interest that may be directly associated in conflict with their duties and responsibilities to and for the Company.
- ii) Any interest which may constitute a conflict of interest of the Company must be promptly disclosed to an appropriate senior manager/team leader.
- iii) Accepting any external appointment, such as a board appointment, working for another organization, or conducting a business, is not permitted without prior intimation and written permission of the management of the Company.
- iv) Trainees should never offer or accept gifts or favor from any other person (being a third party) in circumstances where the outcome of a transaction may be influenced by the gift/favor or give rise to the perception that the transaction may be influenced by the gift/favor.

Any trainee found in violation of this clause shall be terminated from his services with immediate effect by the Company without any prior notice with/without pay, based on the profundity of the conduct of the defaulting party.

2.5 Business Communication

Network and Electronic Resources, such as computers, other hardware, software, e-mail, landline, and cellular telephones, fax machines, printers, scanners, photocopiers, internet access, etc. are tools that TECHAHEAD provides its trainees to assist them in their work. These Network and Electronic Resources and related access systems are proprietary Company's property and are subject to review or access by TECHAHEAD at any time without any prior intimation to such users.

Inappropriate use of networks and Electronic Resources like using personal internet during office hours or using office internet connection for chatting on social media, self-promotion, access to job sites, networking/

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movies/ video/ porn video clip downloading, surfing of social or pornographic website shall result in immediate disciplinary actions, up to and including termination from services without notice.

Trainees shall not download, copy, extract and forward the TECHAHEAD's confidential or proprietary information via e-mail, Bluetooth, pen drive/hard disk/USB flash drives, or any other removable storage medium to any third person outside the office premises of the Company or even to other trainees of the Company unless such recipients are authorized to receive such information. Trainees must not copy or send by e-mail any information, including software that is protected by copyright laws, and the trainees should also be careful to safeguard their passwords, log off their terminals when not in use and not permit others to access Company's systems. They shall further be responsible for the safekeeping of the computer network, computer system, computer database, or any other programmers in such computer, provided to them by TECHAHEAD during their employment.

2.6 Non-Disclosure and non-Solicitation

As the result of their employment at TECHAHEAD, the trainees will acquire and have access to both proprietaries as well as confidential information belonging to the Company of special and unique value. Confidential information shall mean and include but not limited to any and all technical data, materials, products, technology, computer programs, specifications, manuals, business plan software-hardware are configuration/designs, processes, formulae, research projects, invention description(s), technical and business information relating to proprietary ideas and inventions, ideas, trade secrets, drawings and/or illustrations, existing and/or contemplated products and services, research and development, production, cost, profit and margin information, finances and financial projections, customers, clients, marketing and current or future business plans and models and all other information in any form whatsoever that pertains to present or future business operations, processes and nature of work done by the Company or any of customer, irrespective of whether any Non-Disclosure Agreement is signed with the customer or not and regardless of whether such information is designated as "Confidential Information" at the time of its disclosure.

An Trainee shall acknowledge, agree, and undertake the following terms: -

- i) That the Company is the absolute, unrestricted, and exclusive owner of all the Confidential Information as described in the foregoing paragraph.
- ii) That an Trainee during his tenure of service in the Company or 5 (five) years thereafter, shall not, except for a legitimate business purpose of the Company or unless so required by law, use or sale or publish or otherwise disclose, distribute, or divulge to others, any or all such confidential information

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of the Company, in any manner, whatsoever, without the written authorization from the Management of the Company.

- iii) That an Trainee during his employment or five years from the date of his/her termination of services with the Company, use or attempt to use any such Confidential and/or Proprietary Information in any manner which may injure or cause loss either directly or indirectly to the Company, its business, or its existing/previous/prospective customers to who the Company has submitted proposals.
- iv) That an Trainee in possession of any/all Confidential Information of the Company shall use it with the same degree of care and protection that it takes to protect one's Confidential Information
- v) That the Company has received and shall receive in future Confidential Information from third parties, subject to a duty on the Company's part to maintain the confidentiality of such information and to use it only for a limited purpose. An Trainee agrees that owes the Company and such third parties, during the term of his employment and from then on, a duty to hold all such confidential information in the strictest of confidence and not to disclose it to any other person, company, or corporation (except as necessary in carrying out any work for the Company consistent with the Company's agreement with such third party) or to use it for the benefit of anyone other than for the Company or such third party (consistent with the Company's agreement with such third party) without the express written authorization of the Company.
- vi) That while discharging duties/obligations towards the Company if an trainee is in doubt as to whether specific information is to be Confidential or not, the Trainee shall immediately request written clarification from his immediate supervisor.
- vii) That at the time of resignation/termination of his services of the Company, such Trainee shall immediately return all Confidential Information received in written or tangible form, including copies or reproductions or other media containing such Confidential Information, and deliver up to the Company all intangible information relating to the business and operations of the Company that may be in his possession on account of the nature of his duty i.e. passwords, customer lists, project files, etc. to the satisfaction of the Company and shall give an undertaking that the said information has not been unauthorizedly retained by the Trainee in any form. The Trainee shall not attempt to retain or recreate unauthorized copies, notes, extracts, or reproductions of any Confidential Information, record, or other information of the Company. Any failure on this account shall amount to misappropriation of the Company's property and the Company shall have the right to take appropriate legal proceedings both civil and criminal against the defaulter as may be available to the Company under the applicable laws of the country.

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- viii) The Trainees during their employment with the Company or at the time of resignation/termination of his/her services and thereafter shall not steal, conceal, destroy, alter, or cause any person to steal, conceal, destroy, alter any computer source code used for a computer resource to cause damage or disruption of the Company's business.

That an Trainee during the term of his employment and for 3 (Three) years immediately following the termination of his employment with the Company, for any reason whatsoever shall not: -

- i) Hire any trainees of the Company, and will not either directly or indirectly, solicit, induce, attempt to influence, or encourage any of the Company's trainees to leave their employment with the Company or to enter into any employment or other business relationship with any other person (including the erstwhile trainee), Company or corporation or take away such trainees, or make an attempt either for himself or for any other person or entity.

Interfere, solicit either directly or indirectly contact with any of the Company's existing customers previous customers, or prospective customers to whom the Company has submitted a proposal, for the any of the following purposes: a) selling or otherwise providing of similar products or services the Company is in the business of selling or otherwise providing; b) encouraging the former, existing or prospectus customer to cease doing their business with the Company or to curtail its business with the Company or not to commence its business with the Company. Without the prior written consent of the Company: -

- i) serve as a partner, trainee, consultant, officer, director, manager, agent, associate, investor, or otherwise or,
ii) directly or indirectly, own, purchase, organize or take preparatory steps for the organization of, or
iii) build, design, finance, acquire, lease, operate, manage, work or consult for or otherwise affiliate himself, in any business which is in direct competition with or similar to the Company's business in any territory whatsoever.

2.7 Public Statements

The Company's relationships with the media (traditional and social) and the investment community are conducted exclusively by the management of the Company or as delegated by the board.

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The Trainee understands that it is difficult to establish the veracity of posts or comments by him/ her made on the public platform, any social media blogs, or Company review platforms including but not limited to LinkedIn, Glassdoor, etc. Therefore, in view to protect the genuine interest of the Company in the global market, the Trainee during the tenure of his/ her services at TECHAHEAD and for 02 (two) years thereafter shall not make any posts, comments, or reviews in any form at the public platform, any social media blogs, Company review platforms including but not limited to LinkedIn, Glassdoor, Twitter, Facebook, etc. which degrade, defame, malign or cast aspersions on the image of TECHAHEAD.

Non-Disparagement Clause: -

The Trainee agrees that during the subsistence of this agreement or for three (3) years after expiration the hereof he/she shall not through any writing/posting/or any content format on any internet labeling blogs, social media such as Facebook, LinkedIn or Twitter or any other platform, disparage, defame, malign or cast aspersions on the business format, integrity competence or professionalism of the company or its stakeholders unless admitted in writing by the Company or proved in a court of law and upon violation of any such term the delinquent shall remain bound and committed to paying a sum of Rs 2.5 lac carrying interest @ 24% p.a. from the date of such publication till the date of receipt of such money by TechAhead or till the issuance of valid discharge by the Company, as liquidated damages for each instance of any violation as above stated.

2.8 Compliance

1. Trainees must be aware of and adhere to the Company policies, especially those relating to health and safety, equal opportunity, privacy, trade practices, and continuous disclosure.
2. In the course of their duties, Trainees must comply with relevant applicable laws, rules, and regulations both for the individuals and business of the Company.

2.9 Use of Position for Personal Benefit

No trainee shall use his/ her position with the Company for the personal benefit or gain other than the compensation paid to him/ her by the Company, or for the profit or gain (other than the compensation paid to him/her by the Company), or for the profit or gain of any family member.

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2.10 Breaches of the Code

1. Trainees must observe the code and ensure that no breach occurs. Breaches require immediate attention, and Trainees must report known or suspected breaches of the code.
2. Any trainee who in good faith makes a complaint or disclosure about an alleged breach of the code, and follows the reporting procedure outlined below, will not be disadvantaged, or prejudiced in the making of such a complaint or disclosure. All reports will be treated as confidential.
3. A complaint or disclosure about an alleged breach of the code should be in writing and contain details about the date, time, and nature of the alleged breach and include any available supporting material.
4. Complaint, if any, should be made to the Trainee's immediate supervisor/team leader.
5. The person to whom the complaint is made should undertake a prompt and thorough investigation and determine whether any action is required.
6. The Trainee will be informed of the outcome of the investigation.
7. Trainees may at any time discuss a matter or seek advice on how to proceed with a matter, from the Head- of HR & Legal, or any other senior executive.

2.11 Smoking, Drinking, using Recreational Drugs or other intoxicants in the Workplace

TECHAHEAD's policy is to provide a conducive environment for its trainees, customers, vendors, and the general public. Using intoxicants of any kind is prohibited inside the office premises and on the worksites.

Trainees must bring to the knowledge of administration on joining of duties if they use any intoxicants. Furthermore, using them is strictly prohibited during office hours. Any Trainee found consuming alcohol, recreational drugs, or any other intoxicant inside the office premises of the Company during working hours, / shall be terminated from his/her services immediately.

3) HOURS OF WORK AND PAYROLL

3.1 Working Hours

The regularly scheduled workday for the Company is Monday to Friday from 10:00 A.M till 7:00 P.M including lunchtime up to 40 minutes and 20 minutes of short breaks. Trainees can choose his/her lunchtime between 1:00 P.M.-3:00 P.M.

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Official Saturday

Official Saturdays are those Saturdays' when trainees are called for training, official events, urgent meetings, etc. The Company remains closed on Saturdays, however, due to unforeseen project issues, slippages, or training, the trainees might be required to come on the Official Saturdays. Any absence of the permanent Trainee on the official Saturday would lead to deduction of his/ her Casual Leave. However, the absence of a probationer on the official Saturday would lead to the deduction of the one day's salary of the defaulting probationer.

Leave from the office for up to four (4) hours will be considered a half-day leave, however, leave from the office for more than 4 (four) hours will be a full day's leave.

In case of unplanned conditions, such as bad weather, that may force a schedule change at the last minute, the Trainee(s) should contact his/her immediate senior or call the COO & Manager HR directly.

Official Sunday

Sunday is a full holiday and any permanent trainee(s) coming to the office on a Sunday and working for at least 6 hours shall be entitled to an additional full day leave which would be added to their respective Compensatory Off which can be availed after the approval of the Manager HR or PM of the Company.

3.2 Pay Period and Pay Day

TECHAHEAD credits the salary account of every Trainee and provides stipends to every trainee on the 7th day of every English calendar month. The pay periods start on the 1st of every month and end on the last day of the month. Thereafter, on every 7th day of the month, Trainees will receive a salary and stipend (in the case of a trainee) for all the days they have worked in the pay period ending the last day of the previous month.

4) TRAINEE BENEFIT PROGRAMS

4.1 Work from Home

Objective:

This model allows team members to have the flexibility to continue working in exceptional circumstances which doesn't permit the trainee to operate and work from the office. The work-from-home model is open to all full-time team members.

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4.1.1 When Are Team members Allowed to Work from Home: -

- WFH is by exception and not by rule!
- Team members, for exceptional reasons can work from home if permitted by the PM and the HR Manager.

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- It is mandatory to fill Zoho sheets & Keka while working from home & all the security tools must be installed to monitor productivity.
- Team members must be available by Email/Teams/Phone/Text during their working hours. They must respond within 30 mins; no response will be considered as the person is not present for the work and will be treated as unpaid leave.
- In case of any project or team's specific requirement, a team member must report to the office the same day.
- Trainees will not carry out work for anyone other than TechAhead nor undertake any non-work-related activities during their work hours, without the prior permission of TechAhead.
- Trainees shall ensure that they have proper IT system and technology to perform their job/duties from home.
- Trainees will be dealing with the Proprietary and/or Confidential Information of TechAhead, therefore, the Trainees shall strictly comply with the terms of the NDA.
- Reporting manager can approve the Work From Home requests for reasons that include but are not limited to – Parenting, Bad Weather, Family Emergencies, or any Medical Reasons.

Guidelines

1) WFH Allocation and Eligibility

For team members not assigned a permanent WFH status, the following limits apply:

- Quarterly Limit: A maximum of 5 WFH days may be availed per quarter.
- No Carry Forward: Unused WFH days will not carry over to the subsequent quarter.
- Reason-Based Approval: WFH is a facility provided for specific needs. Every request must be supported by a valid reason. Managers are instructed to review the necessity of each request before granting approval.

2) Keka Attendance and Clocking Procedures

To maintain the integrity of our attendance system, the following process is mandatory:

- Advance Approval: WFH must be applied for and approved in Keka prior to the commencement of the remote workday.
- Mandatory Clock In/Out: Once a WFH request is approved, team members must use the Clock In and Clock Out features in Keka.

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- Activity Tracking: You are required to Clock Out and Clock In every time you step away from your workstation during business hours to ensure accurate time logs.

3) WFH vs. Official Duty (OD)

- WFH: While working from home, you only need to Clock In/Out. There is no requirement to mark yourself as "On Duty" (OD).
- Official Duty (OD): The OD status is reserved strictly for instances where you are away on official company business (e.g., attending conferences like AWS re:Invent). In these cases, you are not "working from home" but are performing duties at an external location.

4) Exceptions and Extended Absence

- Policy Exceptions: Any request exceeding the 5-day quarterly limit requires a specific approval hierarchy: Reporting Manager > L2 Manager > L3 Manager. These exceptions must be intimated and approved in advance.
- Extended Absence: If you require more days away from the office than the WFH policy allows, you must avail your Privilege/Earned Leaves.
- Leave Prerequisite: Leaves will only be approved upon the satisfactory completion of all assigned tasks and deliverables due before the leave period.

Non-compliance and Consequence: -

Noncompliance with this Model like damage or misuse of office equipment for personal work or negligent damage or attending to personal work during office hours without the explicit permission of Reporting Manager or HR and any such acts that construe to be a violation of this Model will be viewed seriously by HR and appropriate action is taken including rules from other such policies.

4.2 Performance Review and Appraisal

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4.2.1 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) Policy

Purpose

The Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) is a structured process designed to support trainees whose performance does not meet the organization's defined expectations. The objective of a PIP is to clearly outline performance gaps, set measurable improvement goals, and provide a defined timeframe for improvement.

Applicability

This policy applies to all trainees who are formally placed on a PIP following performance evaluations, feedback cycles, or management review, in accordance with company procedures.

PIP Duration

- The initial duration of a PIP will be four (4) weeks.
- Based on performance review outcomes, the PIP may be extended at the discretion of management and HR if improvement is observed but not yet sustained.
- The decision to close, extend, or take further action post-PIP rests solely with the organization.

Compensation Adjustment During PIP

- Trainees placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) will receive a 15% reduced salary for the entire duration of the PIP period.
- This reduction is not a deferred, recoverable, or on-hold amount.
- The reduced portion of the salary will not be paid at any point, including after successful completion or closure of the PIP.
- Upon closure of the PIP, the trainee's salary will be restored to the original structure prospectively, effective from the date of PIP closure only.
- No arrears, back pay, or retrospective compensation will be applicable for the PIP period under any circumstances.

Performance Review and Support

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- Clear performance expectations, goals, and timelines will be communicated in writing at the start of the PIP.
- Regular review meetings and feedback sessions will be conducted during the PIP period.
- While reasonable guidance and support may be provided, responsibility for performance improvement rests with the trainee.

4.3 Referral Incentive Policy

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to motivate trainees to refer skilled and good candidates to join TechAhead from time to time on a need basis.

Scope

This policy applies to all trainees at TechAhead Software Pvt. Ltd. Except HR & Management

Eligibility

All the permanent Trainees of TECHAHEAD including the new joiners are entitled to the Referral Incentive except those in the HR department and the Management of the Company.

- 1) For referring up to 3 years of experience, a team member can avail of the incentive amount once the referred member has completed 3 months of employment at TechAhead.
- 2) For referring between 3 to 5 years of experience, a team member can avail 50 % of the incentive amount after completion of 3 months and the rest 50 % of the incentive amount after the next 3 months i.e total of 6 months of completion of employment at TechAhead by a referred member.
- 3) For referring above 5 years of experience, a team member can avail incentive amount after completion of every 3 months' total amount will be paid in 9 months of completion of employment at TechAhead by a referred member.

Incentive amounts are as follows: -

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Referral Incentive Amount		
	Years of Experience	Amount (in Rs)
1	6 months to 1	5,000
2	1 to 3	10,000
3	3 to 5	20,000
4	5 to 8	30,000
5	8 to 10	40,000
6	10 and above	50,000

4.4 Meal Reimbursement policy

1. The team members of TECHAHEAD who are working from office-on-office holidays or working beyond 9 P.M. would be entitled to food reimbursement, which will be reimbursed fortnightly. The limit of reimbursement is Rs. 150 per person per meal.
2. That the form for availing this benefit is available with the guard at the reception.
3. The procedure to avail of the benefit is to fill the form and attach the food bill in respect of the meal consumed on that day then the trainee is required to get the same approved by the Project Manager and submit the same to the Account Department.
4. The menu cards of the nearby restaurants are provided by the support staff in the cafeteria who can also arrange for the meals if informed before 8:00 P.M.
5. For carrying out the work smoothly the trainee can share his/ her plans for coming to the office and working over the weekends with the operation team of TECHAHEAD.

4.5 Project Closure Hangout Dinner

After every completion of the project held by a particular team of TECHAHEAD, the delivery head of such team will announce the team – members' names vide e-mail circulated by HR who would be entitled to "Project Closure

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Hangout policy. This policy should be availed in the same month when the project has been completed. It cannot be carried forward in any other month.

The forms for reimbursement of Rs. 500 per person shall be available with the Administrative Department of TECHAHEAD and after filling the same should be submitted to the accounts department after getting it approved from the Delivery head.

4.6 Rewards & Recognition

OBJECTIVE AND SCOPE OF THE POLICY

A rewards and recognition policy is designed to encourage trainees to make a performance difference either individually or through teams. This rewards policy is to appreciate the good work of the Trainees who outperform in their role and set an example for others with their skills, and accomplishments. The scope of this policy is to:

Provide a platform for trainees to create an impact by delivering the best.

Provide Opportunities to get recognized in the area of work at a common platform in the organization.

APPLICABILITY: The policy applies to all trainees of TechAhead Software Ltd.

KEY POLICY CLAUSE: The policy recognizes achievements or accomplishments that contribute to the overall objectives of the organization. The policy may provide both monetary and non-monetary awards.

TYPES OF AWARDS

- 1) Certificates
- 2) Gift Vouchers
- 3) Meals Vouchers
- 4) Plaques, trophies & certificates
- 5) Items such as caps, shirts & sweatshirts

TTYPE OF TRAINEE RECOGNITION

To ensure both fair and consistent application of recognition, a core set of rewards and recognition programs have been developed, as described below. Additional recognition programs may be added as deemed appropriate.

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IMMEDIATE TRAINEE RECOGNITION

This approach provides trainee rewards and recognition at any time for the demonstration of behaviors and values of the organization, contributions to the goals and objectives of the organization or work unit, and acknowledgment of individual or team accomplishments.

Examples include rewards and recognition for:

- Any Client Appreciation Email
- Any PM/RM/HR Appreciation Mail

PLANNED TRAINEE RECOGNITION

This approach is characterized by pre-arranged, more frequently scheduled ways of acknowledging the contributions and accomplishments of an individual or team. This approach is less formal and provides more frequent opportunities to recognize trainees.

Examples include rewards and recognition for:

- i. Teamwork award
- ii. Successful Project Completion Award
- ii. Exemplary Effort Award
- iii. Leadership Award
- iv. Outstanding Achievements award

LEVELS OF TRAINEE REWARDS & RECOGNITION LEVEL

ONE

To recognize a superb job on a project, task or activity or suggestions leading to the improvement of a work process, workflow -Up to 500 cash/non-cash

LEVEL TWO

To recognizes sustained outstanding achievement or contribution above and beyond standard job requirements or suggestions leading to improvements in the work process, workflow - Up to 3000 cash/non-cash

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To recognize an extraordinary achievement or extraordinary contribution requiring a maximum effort that significantly impacted customer service and productivity that is not likely to repeat itself – Surprise Gifts

MANAGEMENT RESPONSIBILITY

1. Each Delivery Head shall determine how the policy is to be administered within their respective areas within the pre-allotted budget.
2. A written plan will be developed that indicates the type of reward and recognition programs to be used, the nomination process, the criteria for determining the level of the award, the approval process, and the communication plan.
3. The written plan will be reviewed by Manager HR for adherence to the organization's policy for recognition and approval at the level of COO before implementation.
4. Based on the individual contributions of trainees who have demonstrated a high level of job performance, quality customer service with adherence to TechAhead mission and values will be declared the winner.
5. Selected trainees will receive a Recognition Award Certificate and other gift prizes.
6. HR will organize **"TechAhead Commendation Day"** in the subsequent month.
7. The winners will be appreciated and rewarded in presence of all Team members.

Disclaimer: The contents of this handbook are presented as a matter of information. The company reserves its rights to modify, change, disregard, suspend or cancel at any time, without written or verbal notice, all or any part of the handbook's contents as circumstances may require.

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5) ADMINISTRATIVE POLICIES

5.1 Attendance

The attendance system followed by TECHAHEAD is a biometric system. All the trainees are compulsorily to register their biometric on a day-day basis each time he/ she enters or leaves the office floor.

- i) The official timings begin from 10:00 A.M. on all working days. However, the grace period of 15 minutes will be available to each Trainee without any salary deduction.
- ii) Grace period of 30 minutes will be available for the next day to only those trainees who leave the office after 9:00 P.M.
- iii) Grace period of 1 hour will be available for the next day to only those trainees who leave the office after 10:30 P.M.
- iv) Grace period of 1 hour 30 minutes is available only to the Trainee who leaves office after 11:30 P.M.;
- v) A Grace period of ½ day (subject to arrival by 2:00 P.M. next) will be available to those Trainees only for the next day who leave office after midnight.
- vi) If any Trainee at a time must go out of the office premises for a period beyond half an hour, he/ she has to seek approval from his/ her delivery head.
- vii) If anyone engaged in client interaction/calls from home, they need to inform HR and their PM/RM.
- viii) If anyone is travelling to the client site should inform HR.
- ix) Those who are late or want to avail short leave the same day should inform the Delivery head and HR by mail or phone/message before 9:30 am, Information, after 9:30 am, will be treated as absent/LWP for the day.
- x) Every 2 days of late arrival (over and beyond the grace time) would equal to 1 half day of unpaid leave. The same would be automatically calculated and affect the number of days for payroll calculation of the trainee.
- xi) Every 2 days of clocking less than 9 hours on the biometric/ time keeping software would equal 1 half day of unpaid leave.

5.2 Dress Code

All Trainees are expected to maintain a clean, decent, and professional appearance. The attire of an Trainee should be consistent with the type of work he/she is performing as well as being appropriate for

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the position such an Trainee holds and the image Company seeks to project. Clothing must be tailored, neat, and clean. Good personal grooming and hygiene are also essential, and all trainees should project a professional appearance during their working hours in the employment.

5.3 Personal Communication

Personal communication has no bearing whatsoever on our Company or the service conditions of our members. Examples of personal communication include emails, telephone calls, messaging/ texting correspondence with friends or family, responses to advertisements, and the purchase of personal goods.

TECHAHEAD values the importance of enabling its trainees to properly balance work and their personal lives. TECHAHEAD recognizes that trainees can use the corporate system to exchange personal e-mail from time to time, particularly in hardship conditions.

5.4 Phone Usage

Trainees are not expected to entertain personal phone calls on their respective cell phones during work hours (except during pre-approved breaks). In cases that any Trainee has to use the cell phone the same has to be done in the cafeteria, meeting rooms, and reception areas within the Company's premises. The team members are strictly barred against:

1. Sitting on their seats and making long-duration personal calls either using a hand-set or otherwise; or
2. Using public areas to make long-duration personal calls; or
3. All landline phones are only available for making and receiving business calls. A business call is defined as a call made for the purpose and with the intent of conducting business or seeking information for the business. If you are found using a landline phone for making personal calls, disciplinary action(s) may be initiated against you.
4. Mobile phones with cameras are not allowed to be used for taking photographs of the office premises, equipment, or personnel.

5.5 Visitors at Workplace

Visitors are only allowed at the Reception or the Visitor's room. Customers, Prospective Customers, and Business Guests if they are accompanied by senior Team Member(s) may be an exception to this policy.

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5.6 Use of Company Property and Intellectual Property

Company property, assets including tangible and intangible, designs, applications, source codes, object codes, facilities, and services must be used only for authorized purposes. Any intellectual property, such as trademarks, copyrights, and any work created by a trainee partly or wholly either individually or together with any person, in the course of employment, or even during or outside the working hours at TECHAHEAD shall be the property of TECHAHEAD and the trainee is deemed to have waived all rights in favor of TECHAHEAD. Work, for this policy, is wide enough to include written, creative or media work. All source material used in a presentation or written documents must be acknowledged.

- i) Trainee shall not use, misuse, or copy any IPR of the Company such as trademark, copyright, design, or patented product/services during his employment with the Company or any time after termination of his services with the Company;
- ii) Trainee shall not use, misuse, copy or disclose any of the Standard Operating Procedure, processes, practices, etc. designed by the Company.
- iii) Any company property (Laptop/ Desktop/ any other hardware or asset) in custody of the trainee shall be kept in safe custody of the trainee. Any theft/ loss or physical damage to such laptop/ desktop or other hardware/ asset would immediately be brought to the notice of the Company. In case of theft or loss of the laptop/ desktop/ hardware or asset the Company could recover the cost from the trainee.

Trainee shall deliver all the Intellectual Property rights in his possession which have either been acquired or developed by him during his employment with TECHAHEAD at the time of his disassociation with the Company along with its copies if any.

5.7 Safety and Accident Rules

Safety is a priority at Company. The company strives to provide a clean, hazard-free, and safe environment. All Trainees are expected to take part in maintaining this environment. All Trainees should observe all posted safety rules, adhere to all safety instructions provided by their supervisor, and use safety equipment when required. It is the responsibility of each Trainee to learn the location of all safety and emergency equipment, as well as the safety and/or emergency phone numbers. Any problems with Company-provided safety equipment should be reported to one's immediate supervisor. If any trainee feels that it is not safe to work for any reason, the problem must be brought to the notice of his/her respective supervisor immediately. All work-related accidents are covered by Worker's Compensation Act, 1923. A first- Aid Kit is

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available in the HR room. The medication from the first-aid kit is supplied for the convenience of trainees and shall be applied by the trainees as per their health conditions and medical requirements.

TECHAHEAD accepts no responsibility or liability arising from the use of the first-aid kit.

6) DISCIPLINARY POLICY

The following outlines TECHAHEAD's policy governing conduct and discipline. This policy is designed to promote peaceful, orderly, and safe conduct of trainees while working in the Company or conducting the firm business, and to protect the Company's reputation in the community by prohibiting certain off-work trainee conduct.

Discipline will be based on factors such as the severity of a violation, the repetitive nature of a violation, the circumstances surrounding a violation, and the frequency of the current or previous violations. Disciplinary actions may include an oral warning, a written warning, suspension with or without pay, and termination. These actions are not required to be taken altogether or in any particular order and TECHAHEAD may begin the disciplinary sequence with any action, including proceeding directly to termination. In all events, disciplinary decisions will be made in the best interests of the firm.

The prohibited conduct listed below represents the types of unacceptable behavior that will result in disciplinary action, up to and including discharge:

- Insubordination, including refusal to follow lawful instructions, rules, or directly from a supervisor (such as refusing to perform jobs other than those the trainee typically performs).
- Theft of the Company's property including but not limited to the confidential as well as proprietary information or the property of other trainees or possessing Company's property including confidential as well as proprietary information or the property of other Company trainees without permission.
- Falsifying or altering Company's records, including employment records, timesheets, or job applications.
- Violation of the Company's policy prohibiting Unlawful Harassment or the Company's Equal Employment Opportunity policy.
- Poor job performance.
- Conduct off the job which causes workplace problems, or which, in the opinion of the Company, reflects poorly on the Company.

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- Wasting Company's materials or supplies.
- Using profanity of a sexual nature or using profanity or another language to taunt or provoke co-workers.
- Unauthorized use of the Company's equipment or materials.
- Violation of the Company's No Solicitation or No Distribution policies.

The list set forth above is not all-inclusive.

7) SEPARATION FROM EMPLOYMENT

7.1 Resignation

Trainees under an employment contract are required to submit a notice of resignation in writing to their respective Delivery Head and HR before the date the trainee intends resignation to take effect as per the notice period clause in the service contract, to assist Company in planning for your departure and replacement for the position of such Trainee.

Trainee agrees to serve the Company with mandatory notice of Thirty (30) days if the trainee wants to resign/leave/terminate his Employment with the Company during the period of his Probation. Salary proportionate to the notice period not served would be adjusted against the FnF if the trainee insists on early relieving. The trainee is not eligible for any experience/relieving letter if the notice period is not fully served. The Company, if it deems fit, can relieve the trainee at any point of time during the trainee's Notice period. In case of early relieving initiated by the Company, the proportionate salary would be paid only till the date that the trainee is relieved.

Trainee agrees to serve the Company with mandatory notice of Thirty (30) days if the trainee wants to resign/leave/terminate his Employment with the Company after his period of Probation and once his Employment is confirmed by the Company. Salary proportionate, to the notice period not served would be adjusted against the FnF if the trainee insists on early relieving. The trainee is not eligible for any experience/relieving letter if the notice period is not fully served. The Company, if it deems fit, can relieve the trainee at any point of time during the trainee's Notice period. In case of early relieving initiated by the Company, the proportionate salary would be paid only till the date that the trainee is relieved.

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Do's & Don'ts During Notice Period:**Dos:**

1. Fulfil your responsibilities: Trainees must continue to fulfil their duties as an trainee until the last day of employment.
2. Handover: During the notice period, the trainee should prepare a detailed handover report and pass on his/her knowledge to his/her successor.
3. Maintain professionalism: Trainees must maintain a professional and courteous attitude during the notice period.

DON'Ts:

1. Speak ill of the company: Negative comments about the company, colleagues, or management during the notice period are strictly prohibited.
2. Breach confidentiality: Trainees must continue to maintain confidentiality during the notice period and avoid sharing sensitive information about the company, clients, or colleagues.
3. Violate policies: Trainees comply with all company policies during the notice period, including the use of company equipment and resources.

7.2 Termination

This termination clause is governed by the service contract according to which the Company reserves the right to terminate the services of the trainee without any notice or salary thereof. However, there are additional grounds on which the Company may terminate the services of its Trainees which are as follows:

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1. If the Trainee fails to report to work without permission or remains absent beyond the period of leave originally granted or subsequently extended.
2. If the Trainee fails to ratify the documents like educational testimonials and details of the trainee's previous employment.
3. Where the trainee suffers from any kind of mental or physical disability thereby preventing him/ her to perform the services effectively.
4. Or in case of misconduct, negligence of duty, disloyalty, dishonesty, indiscipline, disobedience, irregular attendance, unauthorized absence from the duty or inefficiency as compared to the other trainees, or lower performance as compared to the other trainees of his/ her category or any other indulgence of excess or any impropriety in complying with the terms of the HR Manual of the Company.

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5. Or on death/ demise of the Trainee

Notwithstanding the above, the service of an trainee with the Company may be terminated at any time, after confirmation, by giving written notice of such term as prescribed in the Service Contract of the respective Trainee or payment of commensurate salary in lieu thereof. Upon termination of employment for any reason whatsoever, the trainee will immediately deliver to his/ her Reporting Manager at the Company all papers, software programs, notes, data, worksheets, reference materials, memoranda, documentation, software, tools, apparatus, programs, equipment, and any other materials or property physical or intellectual belonging to the Company or that were prepared or made, in whole or in part, by him/her at any time during his/her employment with the Company along with its copies, if any and that which is in his/her possession at the time of such termination.

8) ONBOARDING POLICY

The onboarding policy at TechAhead is designed to ensure a smooth and structured transition for new trainees by familiarising them with the company's culture, policies, and operations. This approach helps enhance engagement, clarity, and productivity from the very first day.

Pre-Joining Process:

Before the joining date, the HR team collects essential documents such as previous employment letters, salary slips, ID proofs (Aadhar, PAN, Passport), address proofs, and educational certificates. As part of the background verification (BGV) process, candidates are required to share employment references. The HR team verifies these references and authenticates the submitted documents to ensure the accuracy of personal, educational, and professional details.

Joining Day Process:

On the day of joining, an trainee ID is generated and the Keka profile is set up by HR. A structured induction session is conducted covering core values, HR policies, the Discipline and Corrective Action Policies, the BGV Policy, medical insurance, company history and achievements, and ISMS training (Information Security Management System). This is followed by floor induction, where new trainees are introduced to senior management and taken on a tour of the office premises.

Access provisioning is then completed, which includes setting up access to Keka, Zoho, Outlook, and Teams, along with laptop allocation based on role or project. Biometric registration is carried out at all three office entry points for attendance tracking, while logical access is provided according to project needs.

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The trainee is assigned a designated workstation, and the IT team ensures the necessary systems and software are in place. A buddy is assigned to each new hire to ease their adaptation into the company culture. HR also assists in opening a salary bank account with the designated banking partner.

To encourage cultural integration, a welcome lunch with the team is organised. Additionally, hands-on Keka training is conducted to guide trainees on attendance, leaves, payroll, and internal HR communications. Finally, the joining documentation is completed, which includes signing the Trainee Service Contract, Appointment Letter, Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA), and a Self-Declaration of HR Manual Form.

9) **EXIT PROCESS POLICY**

The Exit Process Policy ensures a smooth and structured transition when an trainee leaves TechAhead, whether through resignation, termination, or retirement. It is designed to manage exits professionally and in compliance with internal procedures, while maintaining business continuity and protecting company assets. When an trainee chooses to resign, they must submit a formal resignation email or letter to both their reporting manager and the HR department. Upon receipt, HR will schedule an exit interview to gather feedback that may help improve workplace practices. All feedback will remain confidential and will be used solely for internal enhancement purposes.

The trainee is required to complete a thorough knowledge transfer (KT) process before their last working day. This includes documenting all ongoing tasks, sharing critical project details, and handing over responsibilities as directed by the reporting manager to ensure a smooth transition.

As part of the exit formalities, trainees must complete an Exit Clearance Form, which includes approvals from various departments. The IT team will ensure the return of all company-issued equipment such as laptops, ID cards, and devices. Finance will verify the clearance of reimbursements and salary-related dues. Additionally, all system and platform access—including Keka, Zoho, Outlook, Teams, and project-specific tools—will be deactivated on the last working day. Physical access through the biometric system will also be revoked accordingly. The Admin team will collect access cards and other assets. HR will confirm the completion of the exit interview and ensure all documentation is in order.

The final settlement process will be handled by HR, which includes processing pending salary, reimbursements, and issuing key documents such as the Relieving Letter, Experience Letter, and Full & Final Settlement Statement—typically within 30 to 45 days from the exit date.

Lastly, trainees are reminded to strictly adhere to the Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) even after exit and to avoid sharing any confidential or proprietary information acquired during their tenure at TechAhead.

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It is important to note that Company reserves the right to review, revise, delete, add, amend, interpret, modify, or withdraw any portion of the Service Rules contained in the HR Manual at any time at its discretion.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

PLEASE READ THE TRAINEE SERVICE CONDITIONS IN THE HR MANUAL AND FILL OUT AND RETURN THIS PORTION TO THE HUMAN RESOURCE DEPARTMENT ON THE SAME DAY OF YOUR RECEIVING THIS HR MANUAL

Trainee Name: _____

Post Held: _____

I, _____, acknowledge that I have received a copy of the HR Manual wherein the Company's Service Rules containing _____ pages cover all clauses. I have familiarized myself with the contents of the said rules and acknowledge, understand, accept, and agree that I am responsible for knowing and adhering to the policies outlined in the HR Manual during my employment with the Company. I understand that these Service Rules are not intended to cover every situation which may arise during my employment, but as a general guide to the goal, policies, practices, benefits, and expectations of the Company and the terms and conditions in the Service Agreement are more designation specific.

The Company reserves rights to review, revise, delete, add, amend, interpret, modify, or withdraw any portion of the Service Rules contained in the HR Manual, at any time.

Signature of the Trainee:

Date:

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